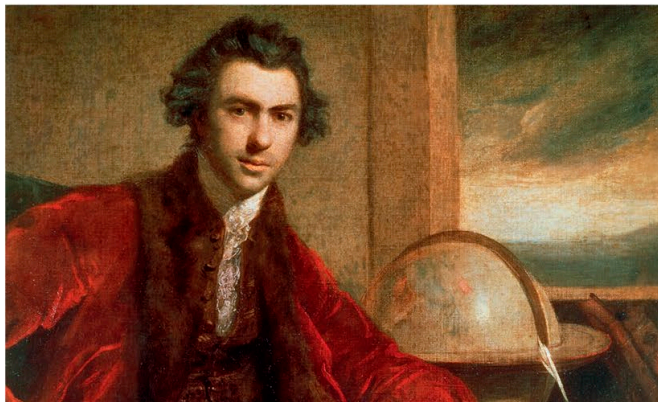


1770

**COOK EXPEDITION REACHES MAINLAND AUSTRALIA**

On 29 April, Cook and the *Endeavour* made landfall at the Kurnell Peninsula. He named the area Botany Bay after Joseph Banks and Daniel Soleander, the expedition's naturalists, recorded 30,000 specimens of plant life, 1,600 of which were unknown to science. While there, they met Aboriginal Australians for the first time.

▽ Joseph Banks, botanist on Cook's expedition



1772

**THE FIRST PARTITION OF POLAND**

By the 18th century, the once powerful Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth was near anarchy. In 1772, its neighbours Austria, Prussia, and Russia agreed to annex portions of the Commonwealth to avoid a war over expansion. Poland lost half its population and almost a third of its land in the partition. Two more partitions, in 1793 and 1795, dismantled Poland altogether.



△ The division of Poland, engraving

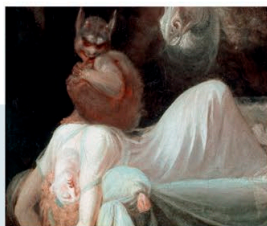
1770

**1771 The Great Yaeyama tsunami** hits Japan, killing 12,000 people in Okinawa

**1771 Plague in Moscow** kills 200,000; riots break out when the authorities enforce quarantines

“Just trust yourself and you’ll learn the art of living.”

JOHANN WOLFGANG VON GOETHE, *FAUST*, PART ONE, 1808

**1770-1850**  
 ROMANTIC  
 MOVEMENT


Romanticism was a European artistic and intellectual movement. A response to the Enlightenment, it explored emotion and nature.

**1774 Johann Wolfgang von Goethe** publishes *The Sorrows of Werther*, a highly influential, sentimental novella.

**1781 Henry Fuseli** paints *The Nightmare*, a disturbing evocation of obsession that hints at the supernatural and at dark sexuality.

**1790 William Blake** publishes *The Marriage of Heaven and Hell*: written like a prophecy, it outlines his Romantic and revolutionary beliefs.

**1801 Ludwig van Beethoven** completes his *Moonlight Sonata*, abandoning traditional constraints to create music that embodies the emotions.